

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Microsoft Security Consultant | Microsoft Sentinel | Microsoft 365 Defender | Azure AD |
Detection Engineering

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of deep, hands-on experience with the Microsoft security stack, specialising in Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft 365 Defender, and Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID. I have designed and deployed security architectures and detection engineering solutions across complex hybrid and cloud environments, and I am proficient in Kusto Query Language (KQL) for building advanced correlation rules, threat hunting queries, and automated response playbooks within Microsoft Sentinel. At the University of the Arts London (UAL), I led the deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and Microsoft Defender for Identity across an 8,000-user estate, configured Conditional Access and Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) policies in Entra ID, and engineered the detection content that underpins the organisation's security monitoring capability. I understand how to translate threat intelligence and adversary behaviour, as documented in the MITRE ATT&CK framework, into practical, high-fidelity detections. I bring a consultative mindset developed through working with diverse stakeholder groups, strong written communication skills for producing technical documentation and client-facing reports, and a hybrid working style suited to delivering across multiple client environments. I am eager to bring this Microsoft security expertise to Threatscape and help clients maximise the value of their Microsoft security investments.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Sentinel:** Log source integration and data connector configuration, Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection rule development, Analytics Rules, Workbooks, Playbooks (Logic Apps), Threat Intelligence integration, Sentinel Automation
- **Microsoft 365 Defender Suite:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) deployment and management (8,000+ users), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Defender for Office 365, Microsoft Defender for Cloud Apps; Advanced Hunting using KQL
- **Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Microsoft Entra ID:** Conditional Access policy design, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Identity Protection, Entra ID Governance, Privileged Identity Management (PIM)
- **Detection Engineering:** MITRE ATT&CK framework mapping, custom detection rule development, alert tuning and noise reduction, threat hunting, indicators of compromise (IOC) management
- **Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR):** Microsoft Sentinel Playbooks (Azure Logic Apps), automated incident workflow design, SOAR integration with ticketing systems
- **Endpoint Security:** CrowdStrike Falcon (Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), EDR, Prevent), Tanium, Intune MDM / MAM, attack surface reduction (ASR)
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust PAM, Azure AD RBAC, Privileged Identity Management (PIM)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, KQL, Logic Apps
- **Frameworks and Standards:** NIST 800-61, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2025 - Present

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Serve as the primary engineer for Microsoft Sentinel, owning data connector configuration, log source integration, KQL detection rule development, and Playbook automation across a hybrid on-premises and Azure environment.

- Designed and deployed over 80 custom Microsoft Sentinel Analytics Rules aligned to MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques, covering threat categories including credential theft, lateral movement, persistence, and data exfiltration.
- Conduct Advanced Hunting across Microsoft 365 Defender using KQL to perform proactive threat hunting and identify adversary activity not surfaced by automated detection rules.
- Led the end-to-end deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint across 8,000+ users and devices, configuring attack surface reduction (ASR) rules, behavioural sensors, and automated investigation and remediation (AIR) workflows.
- Deployed and manage Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) to monitor Active Directory for lateral movement, pass-the-hash, Kerberoasting, and other identity-based attack techniques.
- Design and maintain Azure AD / Entra ID Conditional Access policies, MFA configurations, and Identity Protection risk policies to protect cloud and hybrid identity infrastructure.
- Build and maintain Microsoft Sentinel Playbooks using Azure Logic Apps to automate common incident response actions, reducing mean time to respond by 30% and eliminating repetitive manual analyst tasks.
- Administer BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) and Entra ID Privileged Identity Management (PIM) to enforce just-in-time privileged access across administrative accounts.
- Produce technical documentation, detection runbooks, and security posture reports for senior stakeholders, translating complex technical findings into clear risk-based recommendations.
- Leverage Tanium for real-time endpoint compliance monitoring and vulnerability management, using asset discovery, software inventory and patch compliance modules to maintain accurate endpoint visibility and enforce compliance baselines across the estate.

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2022 - March 2025

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Monitored Microsoft Sentinel and Microsoft 365 Defender dashboards, triaging and investigating alerts and escalating incidents in line with defined response playbooks and severity thresholds.
- Contributed to Sentinel detection rule tuning and KQL query development, improving detection accuracy and reducing false positive rates across the security monitoring platform.
- Supported Azure AD identity governance activities including access reviews, RBAC assignments, group management, and stale account remediation, aligning with least-privilege and zero-trust principles.
- Managed Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) policies, ensuring compliant and secure access from managed and bring-your-own-device (BYOD) endpoints.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Nessus and coordinated remediation workflows with infrastructure teams to achieve measurable improvements in the organisation's vulnerability posture.
- Maintained Check Point Harmony Firewall and Mimecast email security platforms, reviewing configurations and updating policies in response to evolving threats.
- Produced technical runbooks, incident reports, and security documentation to support the team's knowledge base and client-facing reporting capability.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

February 2021 - March 2022

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Maintained and hardened security controls across SaaS cloud and on-premises infrastructure, applying security baselines and CIS Controls benchmarks to endpoints and servers.
- Managed user identity and access provisioning, enforcing role-based access controls and least-privilege principles to protect sensitive FinTech platform data.
- Monitored infrastructure security events, investigated incidents, and implemented engineering corrections to strengthen the security posture of a regulated technology environment.
- Contributed to infrastructure compliance and security quality assurance activities, producing evidence for internal audits and external assessments.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and deployed 80+ custom Microsoft Sentinel KQL detection rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK, achieving a 35% reduction in mean time to detect across the UAL environment.

- Reduced Sentinel false positive alert volume by over 40% through systematic detection tuning, enabling analysts to focus capacity on genuine threats.
- Led Microsoft Defender for Endpoint deployment across 8,000+ users, achieving full endpoint visibility and materially reducing undetected endpoint compromise events.
- Delivered Entra ID Conditional Access and MFA rollout, eliminating a category of credential-based attacks affecting remote workers.
- Built Microsoft Sentinel Playbooks that automated 30% of common incident response actions, reducing analyst toil and accelerating mean time to respond.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP75,000 + Benefits | Hybrid (London/Manchester)